Responsibility Escalation Module (RESM)

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Canonical Definition

Responsibility Escalation Module (RESM) defines the structural conditions under which responsibility associated with a governed identity is escalated to an appropriate governance participant while preserving accountability, traceability, legitimacy, and continuous governability throughout the complete identity lifecycle.

RESM governs responsibility escalation.

The module establishes the governance conditions required to ensure that responsibility is escalated whenever existing governance responsibilities can no longer be legitimately fulfilled.

Responsibility may change.

Accountability must never disappear.

RESM governs that transition.

Module Operational Role

RESM defines the responsibility escalation layer of RIS.

Its role is to preserve continuous governance responsibility whenever operational, organizational, or governance conditions require escalation.

Module Operational Space

RESM governs:

- responsibility escalation,
- accountability transition,
- governance escalation,
- responsibility reassignment,
- escalation governance,
- accountable continuity,
- governance intervention,
- responsibility transition.

Module Function

The module applies wherever responsibility must be escalated from one governance participant to another while preserving accountability.

Minimum Implementation Framework

1. Define the Responsibility Escalation Object

Identify the governed identity and the responsibility requiring escalation.

2. Define Escalation Conditions

Establish governance conditions governing when, how, and to whom responsibility is escalated.

3. Define Escalation Failure Logic

Identify conditions where responsibility becomes abandoned, delayed, ambiguous, interrupted, or governance-invalid.

4. Define Governance Response

Define governance actions for escalation, reassignment, approval, intervention, or governance review.

5. Preserve Escalation Records

Preserve escalation decisions, governance records, supporting evidence, responsibility history, and accountability documentation.

Use Case 1 — Enterprise Identity Governance

Scenario

A governance manager leaves the organization and responsibility for a strategic identity must be transferred to another authorized manager.

Application

RESM governs the escalation and reassignment of governance responsibility.

Result

Responsibility remains continuous, attributable, and governance-approved.

Use Case 2 — AI Identity Governance

Scenario

An autonomous identity management system detects that an operational responsibility exceeds the authority of the current governance participant.

Application

RESM escalates responsibility to the appropriate governance authority.

Result

Governance responsibility remains continuous, legitimate, and fully traceable throughout the complete identity lifecycle.

Canonical Closing Statement

Responsibility must always have an accountable owner. Responsibility Escalation preserves governance continuity by ensuring that accountability is transferred deliberately, transparently, and never left undefined throughout the complete identity lifecycle.

Related Documents

→ Responsibility Integrity Standard (RIS)

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Canonical Source

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